DotJot (`.jot`) Complete Specification v1.0

A plain-text markup standard for multi-style journaling, blending **Fountain** screenwriting syntax, **Bullet Journal (BuJo)** rapid logging, the **Cortex Theme System**, and **Somatic Telemetry**.

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1. Document Metadata Header

Every `.jot` file begins with key-value metadata pairs.

Title: Master Journal Stream

Author: Shelbee Johnson

Theme: Systems & Flow

Anti-Theme: Reactive Thrashing & Manual Burnout

Default Grid: Dot-Grid 5mm

Timezone: America/Los_Angeles

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2. Structural Hierarchy

- `# Year / Era`
- `## Month / Sprint`
- `### YYYY-MM-DD | DAY`
- `#### Sub-block Title`
- `=` Synopsis / Summary line

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3. Rapid Logging & Bullet Journal (BuJo) Syntax

- `[ ]` Unfinished Task
- `[x]` Completed Task
- `[>]` Migrated / Deferred
- `[<]` Scheduled

- `[-]` Cancelled
- `[!]` Priority / Urgent Task
- `-` Note / Observation
- `o` Event
- `?` Investigation / Question
- `!` Epiphany / Idea
- `@context` Context / Location Tag (e.g. `@desk`)
- `*` Priority Signifier

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4. Time-Stamps, Locations & Scene Headings

Adapted from Fountain scene headings.

- Forced headings begin with a period `.`: `.0830 - WORKSHOP BENCH` or `.CAPTAIN'S LOG: STATION 2`
- Unforced keywords: `LOG:`, `ENTRY:`, `INT.`, `EXT.`

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5. Perspectives, Internal Monologue & Dialogue

Inspired by Fountain `CHARACTER` elements.

- **Voices / Mindstates:** ALL-CAPS line preceded by a blank line (e.g. `ME`, `LOGIC`, `CHRONO`).
- **Parentheticals:** Environment, physical state, or sensory cues in `()`.

LOGIC

We need to isolate the power rail before swapping the display module.

ME

(rubbing tired eyes)

Agreed. Let's trace it with the multimeter first.

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6. Telemetry & Cortex Theme Checks

Theme-Check:

Alignment: 5/5

Friction: Low

Direction: Forward

Telemetry:

Sleep: 8.0h (Quality: 9/10)

Energy: 5/5

Water: 80oz

Mood: Focused

Habits: [x] Walk [x] Read [x] Journal

Inline state tags: `[Energy: High]`, `[Focus: Deep]`, `[Status: Blocked]`

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7. Layout Directives

For dot-grid layout design and page rendering:

- `@layout: dot-grid-5mm`
- `@spread: two-page`
- `@grid: blackout`
- `===` Page Break indicator

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8. Annotations, Marginalia & Boneyards

- **Marginalia / Sidebars (`[[ ... ]]`):** Tooltips or sidebar notes.
- **Boneyard (`/* ... */`):** Hidden scratchpads, raw code dumps, or discarded thoughts.

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9. Formatting & Emphasis

- `*italics*`
- `**bold**`
- `***bold italics***`
- `_underline_`
- `~spoken poetry or lyrics~`
- `> Centered Text <`

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10. JSON AST Schema


```
{

 "$schema": "https://dotjot.spec/v1.schema.json",

 "metadata": {

   "title": "Master Journal Stream",

   "author": "Shelbee Johnson",

   "theme": "Systems & Flow"

 },

 "entries": [

  {

    "date": "2026-10-25",

    "synopsis": "Late night ideas and rapid ecosystem planning.",

    "theme_check": { "alignment": "5/5", "direction": "Forward" },

    "telemetry": { "sleep": "7.5h", "energy": "4/5" },

    "blocks": []
```

```
    }
  ]
}
```